

NCE Quick Reference

8 CACREP Content Areas · 101 Key Theories, Names & Facts

PassReady Prep · GA Integrated Therapeutic Perspectives LLC

Professional Counseling Orientation and Ethical Practice

ACA Code of Ethics (2014)

Nine sections, A–I: relationship, confidentiality, responsibility, colleagues, assessment, supervision, research, distance counseling, resolving issues

NBCC Code of Ethics (NCC)

Binds National Certified Counselors; NBCC also administers the NCE

Licensure vs. certification (state vs. national)

Licensure is state law and required to practice; certification (NCC) is voluntary and national

Moral principles (Kitchener)

Autonomy, nonmaleficence, beneficence, justice, fidelity (veracity is often added)

Informed consent (ACA A.2)

Purpose, risks and benefits, limits of confidentiality, fees, records, right to refuse or end services

Confidentiality exceptions (ACA B.2)

Serious and foreseeable harm, suspected abuse or neglect, court order, client waiver

Tarasoff v. Regents of UC (1976)

Duty to protect an identifiable victim from a client's serious threat of violence

Jaffee v. Redmond (1996)

Psychotherapist–patient privilege recognized in federal courts, including licensed social workers

HIPAA (1996)

Federal privacy and security rules for health records; psychotherapy notes get extra protection

FERPA (1974)

Parents may access a minor student's education records; the right passes to the student at 18

42 CFR Part 2 (federal)

Stricter confidentiality for substance use disorder treatment records

Former clients (ACA A.5.c)

Romantic or sexual relationships prohibited for 5 years after the last professional contact

Mandated reporting (state law)

Reasonable suspicion of child or vulnerable-adult abuse is enough; you do not need proof

Clifford Beers (1908)

A Mind That Found Itself; launched the mental hygiene movement

Social and Cultural Diversity

Multicultural competencies (Sue, Arredondo & McDavis 1992)

Counselor awareness of own biases, knowledge of client worldview, culturally appropriate skills

MSJCC (2015)

Self-awareness, client worldview, counseling relationship, counseling and advocacy interventions

Racial/Cultural Identity Development (Atkinson, Morten & Sue)

Conformity, dissonance, resistance and immersion, introspection, integrative awareness

Nigrescence (Cross)

Pre-encounter, encounter, immersion–emersion, internalization (internalization–commitment)

White racial identity (Helms)

Contact, disintegration, reintegration, pseudo-independence, immersion/emersion, autonomy

Gay and lesbian identity (Cass)

Identity confusion, comparison, tolerance, acceptance, pride, synthesis

Acculturation strategies (Berry)

Integration, assimilation, separation, marginalization

Cultural dimensions (Hofstede)

Individualism–collectivism, power distance, uncertainty avoidance, masculinity–femininity

Etic vs. emic

Etic: universal across cultures. Emic: specific to one culture

Microaggressions (Sue)

Microassaults, microinsults, microinvalidations

Cultural encapsulation (Wrenn 1962)

Viewing clients only through the counselor's own cultural assumptions

ADDRESSING (Hays)

Age, Disability, Religion, Ethnicity, Socioeconomic status, Sexual orientation, Indigenous heritage, National origin, Gender

Human Growth and Development

Cognitive development (Piaget)

Sensorimotor (0–2), preoperational (2–7), concrete operational (7–11), formal operational (11+)

Psychosocial stages (Erikson)

Trust, autonomy, initiative, industry, identity, intimacy, generativity, integrity (each vs. its crisis)

Psychosexual stages (Freud)

Oral, anal, phallic, latency, genital

Moral development (Kohlberg)

Preconventional (punishment, self-interest), conventional (approval, law and order), postconventional (social contract, universal principles)

Ethic of care (Gilligan)

Individual survival, goodness as self-sacrifice, morality of nonviolence

Attachment (Bowlby; Ainsworth)

Strange Situation: secure, anxious-avoidant, anxious-ambivalent; Main added disorganized

Zone of proximal development (Vygotsky)

What a learner can do with help; support through scaffolding

Identity statuses (Marcia)

Diffusion, foreclosure, moratorium, achievement (crisis and commitment)

Hierarchy of needs (Maslow)

Physiological, safety, love and belonging, esteem, self-actualization

Ecological systems (Bronfenbrenner)

Microsystem, mesosystem, exosystem, macrosystem, chronosystem

Stages of grief (Kübler-Ross)

Denial, anger, bargaining, depression, acceptance (not strictly linear)

Career Development

Trait and factor (Parsons 1909)

Know yourself, know the world of work, use true reasoning to match them

RIASEC (Holland)

Realistic, Investigative, Artistic, Social, Enterprising, Conventional; congruence; Self-Directed Search

Life-span, life-space (Super)

Growth, exploration, establishment, maintenance, disengagement; Life-Career Rainbow; self-concept

Circumscription and compromise (Gottfredson)

Children rule out careers by sex type and prestige, then compromise on accessibility

Social learning / happenstance (Krumboltz)

Learning experiences shape choices; planned happenstance turns chance events into opportunities

Needs-based theory (Roe)

Early parent-child relationships shape needs and steer people toward or away from working with people

Developmental stages (Ginzberg)

Fantasy, tentative, realistic

SCCT (Lent, Brown & Hackett)

Self-efficacy, outcome expectations and goals drive career interests and choices

Career construction (Savickas)

Career adaptability: concern, control, curiosity, confidence

Cognitive information processing (Peterson, Sampson & Reardon)

Pyramid of information processing; CASVE cycle: communication, analysis, synthesis, valuing, execution

Decision making (Tiedeman & O'Hara)

Anticipation (exploring, crystallizing, choosing) then implementation

Career resources

O*NET replaced the Dictionary of Occupational Titles; Strong Interest Inventory; SDS

Counseling and Helping Relationships

Person-centered (Rogers)

Congruence, unconditional positive regard, empathic understanding: necessary and sufficient conditions

Psychoanalytic (Freud)

Id, ego, superego; defense mechanisms; free association, dream analysis, transference

Individual psychology (Adler)

Inferiority, style of life, birth order, social interest; acting "as if", spitting in the soup

Existential (Frankl; May; Yalom)

Meaning, freedom and responsibility, isolation, death; logotherapy (Frankl)

Gestalt (Perls)

Here-and-now awareness, unfinished business, empty chair

Behavioral (Skinner; Wolpe)

Operant conditioning; systematic desensitization via reciprocal inhibition

REBT (Ellis)

A-B-C-D-E: activating event, belief, consequence, disputing, effective new belief

Cognitive therapy (Beck)

Automatic thoughts, cognitive distortions, cognitive triad (self, world, future)

Reality therapy / choice theory (Glasser; Wubbolding)

Needs: survival, love and belonging, power, freedom, fun; WDEP

Solution-focused (de Shazer & Berg)

Miracle question, exception questions, scaling questions

Narrative (White & Epston)

Externalizing the problem; re-authoring the client's story

Motivational interviewing (Miller & Rollnick)

OARS skills; evoke change talk; roll with sustain talk

Stages of change (Prochaska & DiClemente)

Precontemplation, contemplation, preparation, action, maintenance

Transactional analysis (Berne)

Parent, Adult, Child ego states; games and life scripts

Family systems (Bowen)

Differentiation of self, triangles, multigenerational transmission, genogram

Structural / experiential family (Minuchin; Satir)

Minuchin: boundaries, subsystems, enactment. Satir: communication stances

Microskills (Ivey)

Attending, open questions, paraphrasing, reflecting feeling, summarizing

Group Counseling and Group Work

Group stages (Tuckman)

Forming, storming, norming, performing, adjourning

Group stages (Corey)

Initial, transition, working, final

Therapeutic factors (Yalom (11))

Hope, universality, information, altruism, family recapitulation, socializing, imitation, interpersonal learning, cohesiveness, catharsis, existential factors

Group types (ASGW)

Task/work, psychoeducation, counseling, psychotherapy

Screening (ACA A.9.a)

Screen prospective members to match needs and goals with the group

Johari window (Luft & Ingham)

Open, blind, hidden, unknown

Leadership styles (Lewin)

Autocratic, democratic, laissez-faire

Process vs. content

Content is what is said; process is how members relate while saying it

T-groups (Lewin; NTL)

Training groups focused on here-and-now interpersonal learning

Psychodrama (Moreno)

Protagonist, auxiliary egos, doubling, role reversal; Moreno also created the sociogram

Assessment and Testing

Reliability (consistency)

Test-retest, alternate forms, split-half (Spearman-Brown), internal consistency (Cronbach's alpha), interrater

Validity (accuracy)

Content, criterion (concurrent, predictive), construct (convergent, discriminant)

Normal curve (68 · 95 · 99.7)

Percent of scores within 1, 2 and 3 standard deviations of the mean

Standard scores (M / SD)

z 0/1 · T 50/10 · deviation IQ 100/15 · stanine 5/2 (range 1–9)

Standard error of measurement (SEM)

Builds a confidence band around an observed score

Scales of measurement (NOIR)

Nominal, ordinal, interval, ratio (true zero)

Norm- vs. criterion-referenced

Compared with other test takers vs. against a set standard

Skewness

Positive skew: tail to the right, mean > median > mode. Negative skew: the reverse

Correlation (r from -1 to +1)

Strength and direction; r squared = shared variance (coefficient of determination)

Intelligence tests (Wechsler; Stanford-Binet)

WAIS-IV (adults), WISC-V (children), Stanford-Binet 5

Personality tests (objective vs. projective)

MMPI-3 and MCMI-IV (objective); Rorschach and TAT (projective); MBTI (type)

Beck Depression Inventory-II (BDI-II)

21-item self-report measure of depressive symptom severity

Mental status exam (MSE)

Appearance, behavior, speech, mood and affect, thought process and content, perception, cognition, insight, judgment

Research and Program Evaluation

Type I error (alpha)

Rejecting a true null hypothesis (false positive)

Type II error (beta)

Failing to reject a false null hypothesis (false negative); power = 1 - beta

Choosing a test

t-test: 2 means · ANOVA (F): 3+ groups · chi-square: frequencies · Pearson r: interval · Spearman rho: ordinal

Research designs

Experimental (random assignment), quasi-experimental (no random assignment), correlational, single-subject (AB, ABAB)

Internal validity threats

History, maturation, testing, instrumentation, regression to the mean, selection, attrition

External validity

How well results generalize to other people, settings and times

Bias controls

Hawthorne effect, placebo effect; double-blind designs reduce expectancy bias

Qualitative traditions

Grounded theory, phenomenology, ethnography, case study

Trustworthiness (Lincoln & Guba)

Credibility, transferability, dependability, confirmability

Program evaluation

Needs assessment; formative (during) vs. summative (outcome) evaluation

Belmont Report (1979)

Respect for persons, beneficence, justice; IRBs review research with human subjects

Descriptive statistics

Central tendency: mean, median, mode. Variability: range, variance, standard deviation